

Maria Silva

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Organised, client-focused professional with experience managing high volumes of competing responsibilities accurately and under time pressure. Background spans legal advice, client-facing casework and operational coordination in fast-paced environments. Reliable, detail-oriented and accustomed to taking ownership of processes end-to-end — from managing deadlines and maintaining accurate records to communicating clearly with colleagues and members of the public. Seeking part-time work in Reading to complement ongoing postgraduate study.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Postgraduate study in dispute resolution, evidence analysis and legal research
- Dissertation on data protection law across jurisdictions — awarded Distinction (75%)

Law LLB — 2:1 **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize — top 20 of a 200-student cohort, with partial funding toward undergraduate degree

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead **July 2026 – Present**

Legal Adviser

- Manages a high volume of client-facing appointments daily, including with vulnerable individuals, maintaining a professional and welcoming environment throughout
- Keeps accurate, confidential records for each matter; meets deadlines consistently across competing cases
- Translates complex information into clear, practical guidance for clients with a wide range of backgrounds and needs
- Handles sensitive conversations with discretion and ensures clients leave with a clear understanding of their options

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline — coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines across a complex, high-stakes matter
- Coordinated with external parties and managed multiple workstreams simultaneously under time pressure
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Managed large volumes of documents across several concurrent matters, maintaining accuracy and organisation under competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, and deadline tracking

- Prepared electronic bundles and court materials, requiring high attention to detail and reliable process-following

Q-Legal · Remote**Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a client matter from instruction through to delivery of a formal advice letter, coordinating with the client and a supervising solicitor to meet a fixed deadline
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, practical guidance for a commercial client

Adobe · London**June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve queries and communicate amendments to stakeholders
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on contractual risk and mitigation measures
- Managed documentation review across multiple agreements, flagging issues and communicating clearly with relevant teams

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic filing portals; case management and time-recording systems; electronic bundling and document review

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters